

Patrick Vieira

AI Platform Engineer · London

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PROFILE

I build AI platforms: the developer platform a small London fintech ships with, and the infrastructure, identity and security underneath it. Implementation is agent-drafted inside a delivery system I designed and enforce, and I am accountable for everything that merges. I joined in 2023 to run IT and operations, replaced the managed IT provider with in-house systems, then built the engineering function; I report to the CEO and carry production.

EXPERIENCE

AI Platform Engineer, Altimist Ltd (contract title: IT & Operations Manager) Aug 2023 – present

- Joined to run IT and operations and brought IT in-house, replacing the managed IT provider (£5k+ a month): built the office network (hardware and configuration), set the security baseline, and automated joiner and leaver processes.
- With no platform or engineering function in place, built the developer platform for AI-assisted delivery that everyone at the company now uses daily. Since June 2026 it has been the golden path from spec to merge: a Claude Code plugin and a versioned standards baseline rolled out to about 26 repositories by automated pull request. Three colleagues extend it (40+ of their pull requests merged).
- Agent-drafted, human-accountable delivery: a written spec and acceptance tests first, a gate that blocks an agent from finishing until typecheck, lint and tests pass, and adversarial review by a second vendor's model before I approve and merge. 1,400+ merged pull requests across 40 repositories in ten months.
- One of four engineers on the company's AI assistant product, now in pre-launch: scaffolded it (Next.js on Cloudflare Workers), built its security baseline, and wrote the rules that let its AI triage hand a case to a person, including fixing an instruction revision that talked the model out of escalating.
- Wrote the product's release pack: a timed database restore drill (recovered in 2 min 15 s with no data lost), a rehearsed production rollback and de-duplicated on-call alerting. Diagnosed a public-site outage caused by an origin certificate that could not renew, and removed the dependency on it by serving the domain from the edge.
- Building the Software Factory, an agent execution and evaluation platform on the same golden path: sandboxed runs with per-run credentials, queue-based dispatch with a dead-letter queue and transactional outbox, review stations against written criteria and an automatic revert watcher. Running in staging; no production runs yet.
- Built the first version of the company's identity provider (WebAuthn passkeys on did:web with W3C Verifiable Credentials), the sign-in for internal applications since May 2026, with client libraries published on npm. Handed it over to a colleague in August 2026.
- Run cloud and SaaS infrastructure as code through Terraform Cloud (plan on pull request, apply on merge, daily drift detection): authoritative GitHub access, provider credentials read ephemerally from 1Password, production and staging keys separated. The Microsoft 365 tenant is code too: phishing-resistant admin MFA, a geo-fenced sign-in policy piloted in report-only mode first, and leaver tooling that suspends access in every system and verifies it was removed. Consolidated hosting onto Cloudflare Workers and retired Vercel (Sep 2026).
- Built an on-premises Python speech pipeline on an NVIDIA DGX Spark (NeMo transcription, diarisation, voiceprint speaker naming) for audio that cannot leave the building; it feeds searchable, human-verified records for decision and action tracking.
- Set technical direction through 44 of the company's 61 architecture decision records, and wrote the handovers and onboarding guides colleagues work from.

Software development and retraining, Self-employed Sep 2021 – Aug 2023

- Built Altimist's first website and launch waitlist on the Internet Computer in Motoko, which led to joining the company. Delivered a paid client website while retraining in full-stack development (JavaScript, React, Python, REST APIs, SQL). Tutored A-Level and IB mathematics privately.

- Taught mathematics across Key Stages 3–5, including GCSE and A-Level, adapting lessons to gaps in pupils' understanding. Completed the NQT induction year and a further year.

Earlier: academic tutor and mentor, Leading Lights Tuition (2015–2018); special projects coordinator and volunteer corps member, City Year UK (2014–2016).

SELECTED PERSONAL PROJECTS

- **patrickjv.com**: Personal site and test bed for the golden path: one content file generates its machine-readable copies (schema.org, llms.txt, Markdown, WebMCP tools) and checks the hand-written page against them; a remote MCP server listed on the MCP Registry; 110+ tests and a production smoke monitor. Source public on GitHub.
- **Writing (patrickjv.com/writing)**: Holding agent-written code to the same standard as anyone's; Rehearse the restore, time the rollback.
- **Marine forecast service**: A Python service maintained since February 2026 that emails twice-daily ensemble forecasts to a yacht at sea, with idempotent database migrations, retry handling, a watchdog and delivery monitoring. Public snapshot on GitHub.

SKILLS

Programming	TypeScript, Python, SQL, PowerShell
Platform and delivery	internal developer platforms, golden paths, developer experience, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), GitOps, infrastructure as code, test-driven development, code review, release and rollback practice, architecture decision records
AI	agentic engineering, AI agents, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), LLM evaluation (review gates), speech recognition (NVIDIA NeMo)
Infrastructure	Cloudflare (Workers, Containers, Queues, Durable Objects, R2), Terraform Cloud, Neon Postgres, AWS (organisation and IAM), Microsoft 365 and Entra ID
Identity and security	WebAuthn passkeys, did:web, Verifiable Credentials, conditional access, identity and access management, secrets management (1Password)

EDUCATION

PGCE Secondary Mathematics, University College London (IOE)	2018 – 2019
BEng (Hons) Electrical and Electronic Engineering, 2:1, University of East London	2011 – 2014

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

English (native), Portuguese (fluent), Cantonese (intermediate)